

Nikita Vorontsov

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SUMMARY

Engineering Manager / Lead and Senior Software Engineer working across distributed systems, developer platforms and agentic AI engineering. Experienced in leading cross-discipline squads, line-managing engineers, owning discovery → delivery, and building production systems across Java/Kotlin, Spring Boot, Kafka, event-driven architecture, cloud infrastructure and AI-assisted SDLC tooling.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Python, SQL, Postgres

Backend / Platform: Spring Boot, Micronaut, Kafka, gRPC/Protobuf, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, GCP, CI/CD, Redis, Elasticsearch

AI Engineering: Agentic AI Engineering, Multi-Agent Orchestration, AI-Assisted SDLC, Test Automation, Coverage Verification, LLM Evaluation, RAG, Vector Databases, Prompt Engineering, Claude, GPT, Gemini

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Lead & Senior Software Engineer

August 2024 – Present

Ki Insurance

London, UK

- Lead an 8-person cross-discipline squad across frontend, full-stack engineering, data science, pricing actuarial and data engineering; **line-manage 3** engineers.
- Own discovery → scoping → delivery for complex insurance and pricing-platform work, partnering with underwriting, product, algorithmic engineering and data science to shape roadmaps and sequence delivery.
- Designed and built **agentic engineering infrastructure** for a multi-service quoting platform, using AI coding agents, explicit test-coverage manifests, adversarial review gates and cross-repo automation to make AI-assisted delivery verifiable rather than trust-based.
- Built a **coverage-verification system** mapping fields × test axes × pass/fail states, requiring each coverage claim to cite a real, current passing test before it can count as complete.
- Introduced **adversarial review workflows** for AI- and human-authored changes, catching pre-merge defects including silent data-mapping issues, financial-boundary rounding errors and pricing threshold crashes.
- Created persistent **knowledge-base and memory workflows** for AI agents, using versioned skills, observed failure logs and mistake-to-skill feedback loops to reduce repeated steering and improve reliability across sessions.
- Delivered self-service developer tooling for one-command cross-repo environment replication, automated service bootstrapping, schema/manifest drift detection and hermetic test dependencies.
- Kept **three concurrent programmes** on track by capping WIP, mapping dependencies and running weekly risk reviews; delivered predictably without slippage.
- Established engineering practices for a mixed technical/non-technical squad, including Definition of Done, project breakdowns, acceptance criteria, on-call runbooks, observability basics and production-readiness standards.
- **Hands-on:** Kotlin/Java, Spring Boot, event-driven services, gRPC/Protobuf-style contracts, cloud infrastructure and production reliability work.

Tech Lead

September 2022 – August 2024

NatWest Boxed / Mettle

London, UK

- Led system design, architecture, planning and delivery for core product features across a Kafka-based event-driven microservices estate.
- Acted as technical lead for a team of up to **15 developers**, providing architectural direction, delivery sequencing, technical review and hands-on implementation support.
- Architected and led implementation of **Kafka-based event-driven microservices**, improving scalability, reliability and separation of domain concerns.
- Implemented state-machine architectures within Micronaut microservices, using Kafka events for domain transitions and clearer service behaviour.
- Owned project planning and delivery management, including forecasting work, sequencing dependencies and aligning engineering capacity to roadmap commitments.
- Improved team delivery practices through clearer sprint structure, engineering rituals, technical planning and onboarding standards.

- Mentored graduates and new engineers, enabling engineers with no Java experience to become productive within two weeks.

Senior Software Engineer

August 2021 – September 2022

NatWest Boxed / Mettle

London, UK

- Designed and developed scalable, fault-tolerant backend services using Java, Spring Boot, Micronaut and Kafka.
- Introduced Kafka-based event sourcing and CQRS patterns into backend systems, improving resilience, auditability and service boundaries.
- Provided technical leadership for in-app account recovery, coordinating frontend, backend and third-party integration work.
- Pivoted account-recovery delivery after a third-party provider could not deliver the original solution, rapidly planning and implementing an alternative path.
- Improved security around third-party integrations by implementing user-hash authentication mechanisms.
- Led discovery and technical negotiation with third-party providers, translating external constraints into workable engineering designs.
- Created a central tools repository for common commands and operational workflows, improving onboarding and reducing repeated setup friction.

Software Engineer

August 2017 – August 2021

Landbay

London, UK

- Developed a custom data pipeline to extract information from multiple microservices, transform it and load it into AWS Redshift for analysis.
- Designed and implemented a Java library for writing large files to AWS S3, enabling reliable sharing of high-volume data between microservices.
- Improved performance of a Flowable-backed microservice by **700%**, reducing response time from **4 seconds** to **0.5 seconds**.
- Designed and implemented re-indexing workflows for custom Elasticsearch-backed search functionality.
- Mentored and trained an apprentice and supported onboarding for new joiners across multiple experience levels.

PROJECTS

CharGen – AI Content Platform | *Java, Spring Boot, AWS, React, Stripe, LLMs, RAG, Multi-Agent* October 2023 – Present

- Designed and built a production AI content platform for tabletop-RPG creators, covering text generation, image generation, video workflows, session-note processing, payments and user-facing content workspaces.
- Implemented LLM orchestration pipelines including prompt chaining, structured output parsing, validation, retry strategies, model fallback and iterative refinement.
- Built Retrieval-Augmented Generation workflows using embeddings and vector search to support grounded generation over large content corpora.
- Architected a multi-agent session-note generation system: audio transcription → chunking → parallel LLM extraction → cross-chunk deduplication → reconciliation → final structured output.
- Applied LLM evaluation techniques including regression testing, output scoring, prompt-strategy comparison and model-quality checks across production workflows.
- Integrated AI models into production microservices handling real user traffic, managing inference latency, cost optimisation, structured output parsing and error handling.
- Owned full-stack product delivery across Java/Spring Boot services, React/TypeScript UI, AWS infrastructure, Stripe billing and production operations.

Beer Flow Monitor | *Raspberry Pi 4, Python, YF-S201 Flow Meter, AWS, SQL*

May 2020 – May 2021

- Designed and built a flow-meter system to measure beer volume remaining in a keg.
- Implemented a Python algorithm using hall-effect sensor readings to calculate pour volume and remaining keg volume.
- Displayed output on an LCD screen and pushed measurement data to an AWS RDS database.

EDUCATION

King's College London

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, First Class Honours

London, UK

September 2014 – August 2017

INTERESTS

Brewing, Gardening, Building/DIY, Archery, Techno, Aquariums, Data, TTRPGs